Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣K

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥J

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠10

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7 5
♦ K 6
♣ 8 3

♠ 10 9 8
♥ 9 4 3 2
♦ J 9 8
♣ A 9 4



♠ A 6 3
♥ 8
♦ 10 7 5 4 3
♣ K Q J 5

♠ K J 5
♥ A K 6
♦ A Q 2
♣ 10 7 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

NORTH, with a 5-card AND a 4-card Major first uses Stayman.

SOUTH denies a 4-card Major, so NORTH realizes that ♠s are out. He then bids ♥s, promising five of them.

SOUTH not only has three ♥s, she also has 17 points so she bids 4♥.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ A 9 8 4 3 ♦ J 10 8 3 ♣ Q J 4	
♠ Q 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 7 5 ♦ K 7 ♣ 8 3	N W E S	♠ A K J 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A Q 6 2 ♣ 10 7 2
	♠ 10 9 8 6 ♥ 2 ♦ 9 5 4 ♣ A K 9 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♣K

This is a companion hand to Deal 16.

EAST shows four ♠s following WEST's Stayman bid.

So WEST ignores her five ♥s, having already found an 8-card Major suit fit. With the fit her hand now revalues to 11 points so she bids 4♠.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 7 5 ♦ K 7 ♣ 8 3	
♠ J 9 8 6 ♥ A 4 ♦ J 10 8 ♣ A 9 6 4	N W E S	♠ 10 3 ♥ 9 8 3 2 ♦ 9 5 4 3 ♣ K Q 5
	♠ A K 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A Q 6 2 ♣ J 10 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♣4

This is companion #3 to Deal 16 and 17.

NORTH again starts with Stayman, and after SOUTH denies a 4-card Major, NORTH shows her five ♥s.

But in this Deal SOUTH has only a doubleton ♥, so he chooses to play 3NT.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 7 3
♥ J 10 8
♦ A 10 8 4 2
♣ 10 5

♠ Q 10 8 6 5 4
♥ Q 7 5 3
♦ 7
♣ A Q



♠ K J
♥ A K 6
♦ J 9 5 3
♣ K J 9 6

♠ 9 2
♥ 9 4 2
♦ K Q 6
♣ 8 7 4 3 2

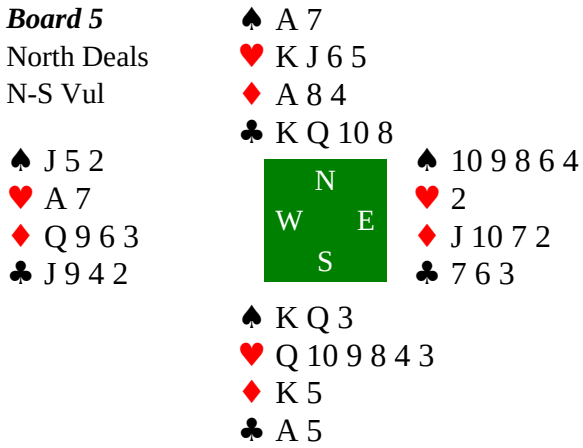
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥J

Even with a 6-card ♠ suit WEST uses Stayman because he also has a 4-card ♥ suit. Given a choice, playing a 4-4 Major fit is usually preferable to a 6-2 or even a 6-3 fit.

But here EAST doesn't have four ♥s so WEST just bids the game where he knows the partnership holds eight trumps.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠10

NORTH breaks the expected Transfer sequence by jumping to 3♥ instead of bidding just 2♥. This is called the "Super Accept" and it shows a hand with four of the trump suit with maximum point count.

SOUTH's ♣ bid and NORTH's ♦ bid are Control bids, showing first round control of the suit that was bid.